COVER LETTER

Dear Sir/Madam,

My name is Muhammad Adnan. I have done B.E Electrical (Telecom) engineering from National University of Sciences and Technology (NUST) in 2010 and a Gold Medalist in MBA (Marketing) from Shaheed Zulfikar Ali Bhutto Institute of Science and Technology (SZABIST) in 2015.

Currently, I am working as a Global Acquisition Manager at Centre for Evaluation and Development (C4ED), which is a Germany based organization where I am managing the preparation and submission of bids (EOIs / Proposals) for new projects for various donors e.g. World Bank, UN agencies, GIZ, FCDO etc. and ensuring submission of high quality, compliant and competitive proposals. I am also involved in market screening, conducting research on possible partners, client priorities and current programming related to donors and specific projects.

Before taking up my role at C4ED, I also worked briefly as a Chief Growth Officer at Cretesol (Pvt.) Ltd., Pakistan's most premium stone and tile brand. I was looking after nationwide marketing and sales, strategic business development, and enhancing digital footprint and portfolio.

Prior to C4ED, I have worked as a Program Manager Policy Advisory at Centre for Economic Research in Pakistan (CERP) where I was steering World Bank funded "CLEAR Initiative - Centers for Learning on Evaluation and Results" at The Ministry of Planning, Development & Special Initiatives (MoPD&SI), GoP. The project is aimed to strengthen monitoring and evaluation capabilities and inculcate an evidence-based approach to decision making. This role also focused on program development and new business development activities (projects / consulting assignments / research studies etc.) which emanated from grants, competitive proposals and the partner network.

Previously, I have worked as a Technical Advisor Centre of Excellence (CoE) in Technical and Vocational Education and Training Sector Support Programme (TVETSSP) at Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ) GmbH (a Germany based organization); managing and implementing all interventions (Governance and Management & Finances, Sustainable Service Delivery, Information Technology and Systems, Quality Safeguards, Conducive and Compliant Training Environment, Establishment of Partnerships with TVET landscape, Visibility and Outreach) for the transformation of an existing government training institute functioning under Ministry of Federal Education and Professional Training (MoFEPT) into a state of the art centre of excellence (CoE) envisioned to be a hallmark of technical and vocational education for students, teachers and the industry.

Before joining GIZ GmbH, I was working as Business Improvement Manager at British Council Pakistan where I was leading change initiatives (people, process and technology) for cost efficiency, business and process improvement as part of the management and implementation of Exams Transformation Program under GNOME (Global New Operating Model for Exams). Overall mandate was to enhance the effectiveness and efficiency of operational delivery of all exam products and services through implementation of business improvement approaches as part of the global business improvement strategy.

Before joining British Council, I was working as Assistant Manager Corporate Strategy at PTCL Etisalat Islamabad with prominent exposure at CxO level. I was working directly with the CEO’s office on high impact cross-functional projects and special assignments pertaining to commercial business planning, enterprise risk management, customer experience, market and industry research, incubation/accelerator program, knowledge management and operational excellence.

Prior to PTCL, I worked as Product Management Executive in Commercial Division at Rockville Technologies (Pvt.) Ltd. Islamabad.

Previously, I had worked for two years in NAYAtel (Pvt.) Ltd. Islamabad in various capacities including technical support, operations engineer and team lead managing various teams and projects with a fair experience of quality customer interaction.

Regards,
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CAREER SUMMARY

An experienced project and program management professional with strong business acumen who has worked in different industries (telecom, education, non-profit, international development cooperation and think tank) in a variety of roles ranging from operations, product management, business development, corporate strategy, business improvement, technical and policy advisory. I have been engaged in senior stakeholder management roles working directly with the donors and government. I am a team player dedicated to motivating and mentoring colleagues within multicultural settings.

EXPERIENCE

Global Acquisition Manager (Business Development & Partnerships) **Apr'23-Present**
Centre for Evaluation and Development (C4ED), Islamabad

- Market screening for opportunities
- Preparation and submission of applications (EOIs / Proposals) for new projects for various donors e.g. World Bank, UN agencies, GIZ, FCDO etc.
- Manage the proposal process through all phases to ensure submission of high quality, compliant and competitive proposals
- Coordinate project proposal writing including one's own contributions to project applications
- Conduct research on possible partners, client priorities and current programming related to donors and specific proposals
- Communicating and liaising with project partners and donors
- Quality Management and continuous improvement of project acquisition processes
- Knowledge management – organizing and maintaining proposal folders, documents and business development resources
- Prepare and improve short marketing and communications material
- Support social media and web content development
- Contributing to public relations including short translations
- Administrative duties with global and Pakistani authorities

Senior TPM Consultant **Feb'23-Jan'24**
International Advisory, Products and Systems (i-APS), USA / Turkiye (Remote)

- Leading multiple cluster's third-party monitoring and verification (TPM&V) projects for United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (UNOCHA) Syria Cross-border Humanitarian Fund (SCHF) program

Program Manager Policy Advisory **May'22-Jan'23**
Centre for Economic Research in Pakistan (CERP), Islamabad

- Managing and implementing World Bank funded (budget of approx. 1.3 Mn USD) "CLEAR Initiative - Centers for Learning on Evaluation and Results" at The Ministry of Planning, Development & Special Initiatives (MoPD&SI). The project is aimed to strengthen monitoring and evaluation capabilities and inculcate an evidence-based approach to decision making
- Project Management:
  - Effectively managing the project to achieve project goals and outcomes, including coordinating with MoPDSI
  - Effectively communicating and collaborating with other CERP verticals (such as Data Analytics, Labs, Executive Education) to enhance inter-vertical coordination for a holistic problem-solving approach for achieving intended outcomes
    - Conducting needs assessment exercise – interviews, questionnaires and FGDs
    - Data analytics – working on process improvement initiatives reviewing PC1-PC5, updating relevant chapters in Planning Commission's PIM (project implementation manual) leading to development of a dedicated M&E framework
    - Labs – technological interventions in PMES (project monitoring and evaluation system) to support proposed changes/process improvements
    - Executive Education – capacity building for relevant staff on proposed changes and new processes (e.g. M&E bootcamps etc.)
    - Policy Advisory – project management, outreach and partnership development with allied ministries and government institutes, creating knowledge-based products (e.g. M&E best practices comparative matrix, Indian Planning Commission vs NITI Aayog, lessons learned documents)

- Reporting and Project support:
  - Preparing policy briefs, blog posts, progress reports for govt. and donor
    - Updating World Bank's prescribed M&E framework for the project "MESA tool – monitoring evaluation and system analysis" (comprehensive tool starting from contextual analysis, identified gap, recommendations and the logframe)
    - Updating budget planning tool for activities
  - Supporting in the delivery and execution of the project deliverables associated with all verticals (approvals, revisions, information gathering via formal and informal channels, access to documentation etc.)
  - Contributing to and updating PI's manual (principal investigator manual)
- Business development and stakeholder management:
  - Proactively identifying, liaising with and managing MoPDSI and World Bank stakeholders
  - Identifying opportunities for engagement with donor and government partners and building a pipeline of projects emanating from MoPD&SI
  - Program development / new business development activities (projects / consulting assignments / research studies etc.) which emanated from grants, competitive proposals and the partner network
    - This involved major synergy creation with Survey and Research units within CERP and with external consultants for creating research methodology and data collection tool development for proposals/research studies

Technical Advisor Centre of Excellence (CoE) **Apr'20-Dec'21**
Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ) GmbH, Islamabad

- Managing all interventions (Governance and Management & Finances, Sustainable Service Delivery, Information Technology and Systems, Quality Safeguards, Conducive and Compliant Training Environment, Establishment of Partnerships with TVET landscape, Visibility and Outreach) related to the establishment of CoE (budget of approx. 1.8 Mn Euro)
- Coordinating with TVETSSP national and international subject matter experts and advisors for the achievement of criteria of completeness as specified in the project administrative document and operational action plan for the establishment of CoE
- Navigating complex stakeholder and partner structure by providing technical advice to partners, CoE staff, officers of the line department (ministry of federal education and professional training) and CoE management (including NAVTTC / Director General Islamabad) regarding organizational development measures, structures and processes
- Supporting in capacity development measures, establishment of an institute management committee (IMC) and career counselling and job placement unit (CCJP), deployment of digitized monitoring and evaluation system, accreditation of CoE as a training provider and assessment centre and introduction of an internal human resource development plan
- Facilitating engagement of stakeholders and identifying potential business development activities
  - Partnerships with stakeholders of private and public sector (associations, employers, accredited training institutes, qualification awarding bodies, staff training institutes)
- Facilitating the procurement of equipment and tools, upgrading and setting up of labs and workshops as well as the conduction of civil / renovation work
- Drafting ToRs for outsourcing services and managing STEs (short term experts)
- Monitoring (updating the logframe – activities and respective indicators, prescribed standard templates etc.) and reporting progress on implementation of activities to stakeholders (govt., donors)

Business Improvement Manager **Aug'17-Mar'20**
British Council, Islamabad

- Leading initiatives for cost efficiency, business and process improvement
- Monitoring, mapping, conducting gap analysis and standardizing existing processes to ensure all relevant examination services operational protocols and standards are aligned nationally across all regions (ISB, KHI and LHR)
- Conducting audit of current SOP's on an on-going basis and suggesting system and process improvements for optimum delivery of examination services and products
- Centralization (hub model) of various pre-exam & post-exam activities & processes e.g. sorting and confidential material distribution activities for school exams with Cambridge and external stakeholders (FeDex, UPS), refund of payments for IELTS etc.
- Rollout and implementation of new global processes and system initiatives across the country under GNOME (Global New Operating Model for Exams) initiative - standardization in approach and implementation of the new global processes and systems (Back Office Scheduling System - BOSS, Automated Venue Staff Payment - AVSP, LMS - Learning Management System, Clock In Clock Out - CICO, School Registration System – SRS, Online Registration System - ORS, IELTS Web Administration System – IWAS, On-Screen Marking - OSM, ORS2 and Plan Exams)
- Coordination with global system owners (UK, South Asia) and regional operations (South Asia) for implementation of GNOME systems and projects and for resolution of issues related to them

- Ensuring pragmatic communication (reports, presentations etc.) with senior leadership and staff regarding any change initiative involving people, process and technology
- Cross functional support to other SBUs and teams
  - Conducting country wide interviews for venue staff recruitment exercise for massive May June Cambridge exam session

- Projects:
  - IELTS candidate journey standardization and venue staff optimization across Pakistan which resulted in a saving of 32K GBP approximately
  - School exams candidate journey standardization and venue staff optimization across Pakistan; projected savings of at least 100K GBP
  - Venue capacity project with operations and procurement (identification of new venues for paper and computer-based exams, latent capacity of existing venues, GIS mapping) to meet the future capacity demand of exams
  - Online Learning Management System (LMS) roll out for 4500+ venue invigilation staff transforming F2F training through online mandatory trainings and assessments which resulted in a saving of 11.4 Mn PKR (60K GBP) against venue procurement and travel cost
  - Automation of payment for 2700+ venue invigilation staff via in-house SAP vendor creation and payment run through automated venue staff payment *(AVSP)* process into the bank accounts
    - Getting nationwide venue staff to fill required data (bank account number, bank key, branch code etc.) on venue staff portal (VSP)
    - Uploading required documents (cross cheque or account maintenance certificate, ID document such as CNIC or passport) on back office scheduling system (BOSS)
    - Vendor creation through Shared Service Center (SSC) SAP team
    - Payment run into individual bank accounts through SSC SAP team
  - Automation of payment for 2000+ venue invigilation staff through *Easy Paisa* for payment of their services rendered in mammoth Cambridge May June'18 exam session
    - Outsourced payment to Telenor Bank's Easy Paisa
    - Easy Paisa accounts were created free of cost (FOC) for each of the venue staff post required documentation
    - Payments were transferred to Easy Paisa accounts and management fee of 0.1% per transaction was charged to British Council and not to the end customer i.e. venue staff
  - Proposed and implemented a new process of handling of bank instruments in the organization resulting in a saving of 0.7 Mn PKR/annum nationally (a reduction of 73% in cost as compared to previous practice) utilizing in-house Receipt Manager tool and National Collection Service (NCS) of Standard Chartered Bank (SCB)
  - Computer Delivered (CD) IELTS roll out transforming paper-based delivery to online computer-based delivery with the benefit of superior customer experience and early result delivery as opposed to conventional paper-based testing - candidate journey mapping (end-to-end and test day) for nationwide standardization and venue capacity expansion plan CBA (cost benefit analysis) for future business needs
  - Standardized and optimized venue staff general pool F2F training content at national level to the essentials only resulting in considerable time and cost saving by limiting the activity to one day

Assistant Manager Corporate Strategy **Mar'15-Jul'17**
PTCL Etisalat, Islamabad

- Yearly roadmap/product calendar planning, implementation and evaluation
  - Variance between actual vs planned targets in terms of revenue, profits and customer growth
- Corporate performance reporting
  - Director's report with marcoms, annual report with finance, presentations and executive summaries etc.
- Business planning with finance
  - Populating inputs for various variables in the planning workbook
  - Comparison of financial statements for period to period and YoY basis
- Preparation of inputs and suggestions on policy matters regarding PTA, USF and MoIT with regulatory affairs
  - Price floor discussion
  - Comments on annual license fee rationalization
  - Abolishment of Universal Service Fund (comments on unutilized funds of USF)
- Consolidation of Enterprise Risk Management (ERM) activities under Etisalat Group guidance for the OpCo
  - Populating the ERM framework template with information gathered from various functions
  - Identification of organizational risks, risk mitigation strategies, top risks dashboard and risk radar
- Market and industry research (Ovum, Analysis Mason, data from various government sources like PTA, PBS etc.)
  - Conducted in-house survey with market research team - "Survey of top 100 customers of tier-2 cities for understanding customer awareness level and preferred purchasing channel for PTCL's products and services"

    - Collaborated with TNS Global and Nielsen on a demographic survey for identification of high value green field areas for commercial rollout of fiber-to-the-home (FTTH) broadband services
- National Fiberization
    - Resourcing plan (organogram, roles and responsibilities, team formation and costing) for a specialized FTTH strategic business unit (SBU) within the organization for delivery of GPON services in high value green field areas
    - Nationwide FTTH spots identification in a scientific manner for FTTH rollout with commercial, regional and technical teams
    - FTTH packages bundling and after sales services
- Bad debt scenarios and recommendations to clear backlog of 8.24 Bn PKR
- Sensitivity analysis for DTH (direct-to-home) and Network Transformation (Top 100 exchanges) projects
- National Incubation Center funded by National ICT R&D Fund (MoIT)
    - Department's focal person for RFP response preparation with PTCL's Digital Services team in strategic collaboration with LMKT (Pvt.) Ltd.; PTCL and LMKT in this partnership won the RFP for establishment of National Incubation Center at Peshawar
- Utilized "micro strategy" an SQL language-based tool for extracting various business reports to perform data analysis and developing actionable insight from business intelligence data
- Value chain analysis and re-engineering of business processes
    - Network operations center (NOC) optical fiber cut escalation process redesign with NOC team to include escalation alerts up to CEO level
- Interface between strategy and marketing department for branding of "HI SPEED" broadband on various one stop smart shops (OSS) and integration of UPaisa with PTCL smart shops
- Worked as a focal person with marcoms and digital Services team to promote and send nominations for "Smart Link" application to various regional and global forums e.g. GSMA Asia Shanghai 2016, GSMA Global Mobile Awards (GLOMO) 2016, Etisalat Group Excellence Award 2017
- Central Document Repository – focal person for managing departmental documents with internal and external stakeholders through Microsoft SharePoint portal fostering knowledge management
- Prepared and tracked departmental budget of 1 Mn PKR on SAP

➢ Secondment: Ufone Etisalat (May 2016 – June 2016)
    - Worked on various strategic projects and presentations including regional strategy and USF bids

Product Management Executive **Jan'15-Mar'15**
Rockville Technologies, Islamabad

- Proposal preparation, product health measurement (revenue, growth etc) and reporting for value added services [SMS, IVR, WAP, Mobile App]
- Contract management with clients (financial and technical terms and conditions)
- Key accounts management e.g. telcos, government institutions like PTV, HEC
- End-to-End management of assigned project / product (action plan, coordination, deliverable)

➢ Major Work Streams:

    - Supply of tablet hardware and software for the Pakistan Reading Project executed by Equal Access International (EAI) and funded by USAID
    - PTV ICC WC Cricket App and co-branding with telcos
    - All @ 1 AED for Etisalat UAE
    - WARID Panic Call
    - TELENOR Bulgaria Double Number Service
    - Promotional Campaign Plan for TELENOR's Smart Number Service
    - Unified Web Streaming and Recording System for HEC

Business Development Executive (Intern) **Jul'14-Aug'14**
Zeta Technologies, Islamabad

- Bringing in business from customer, maintaining and building up the relationship as part of daily operations
- Negotiating rates for the voice traffic volume
- Key accounts management (managing various traffic aggregators)

Network Engineer **Jan'11-Jan'13**
NAYAtel, Islamabad

- Pre-sales and technical surveys in the assigned geographic territory
- Managed home and corporate deployments in assigned territories in Islamabad and Rawalpindi in the field in all weather conditions & seasons with a quality check (QC) score of above 90%

- Managed operations & maintenance (O&M) activities 24/7 in shifts to ensure 99.9% network up time
- Planning and implementing passive optical network capacity optimization activities
  - Network offloading and rehabilitation
- Improving existing and preparing new departmental SOP's
- Updating training manual and conducting induction and technical trainings of junior staff
- Delivery of deployment projects for corporate clients e.g. HBL, HEC, Government institutions etc.
- Managed a team of six members (work schedule, performance management, training and development needs)

➢ Projects:

  - Network transformation (transition in vendor from Alcatel Lucent to Huawei) - performed product acceptance test (Ranging and RF overlay) with Huawei for deployment of its Gigabit Passive Optical Access Network solution (MA5600T) in Islamabad & Rawalpindi (2012)
  - Installation of ODF's and laying of 12F and 72F cables in Centaurus, Islamabad (2012)
  - P2P connectivity of twelve HBL branches in Islamabad (2011)
  - Provisioning of triple play services at PTI Chairman's house in Bani Gala, Islamabad (2011)
  - Tariq Heights, Islamabad - Provisioning of triple play services (2012)
  - Wardah Hamna Towers, Islamabad - Provisioning of triple play services (2012)

EDUCATION

2015 - MBA (Marketing), Shaheed Zulfikar Ali Bhutto Institute of Science and Technology (SZABIST)
2010 - B.E Electrical (Telecommunications), National University of Sciences and Technology (NUST)

PUBLICATION

Global Evaluation Initiative (GEI) Week: Best Practice Analysis to Improve M&E Systems in Pakistan, American Evaluation Association (AEA) - Sep 20, 2022 Link

TRAININGS

- Toyota 5S Methodology (Toyota 5S Ecological Conservation Program), Toyota Indus Motors - conducted via United Nations Association of Pakistan (UNAP) (17th Apr. 2022)
- Capacity Works (Cooperation Management for Practitioners), GIZ GmbH - conducted via Conrad Consulting Switzerland (9th Feb. – 25th Feb. 2021)
- Didactic (Pedagogy) Method Training, GIZ GmbH (20th Jan. 2021)
- Occupational Health and Safety in Construction Industry, GIZ GmbH - conducted via Excellency Abinitio Services (19th Jan. 2021)
- Problem Solving and Decision Making, British Council - conducted via LUMS (4th Dec. - 7th Dec. 2018)
- Line Management Skills, British Council - conducted via Carnelian (30th Nov. 2017)
- McKinsey's 7 steps of Problem Solving, PTCL - conducted via McKinsey Dubai (7th Jun. 2017)
- Taking Ownership and Speedy Execution, PTCL Academy (4th Jan. 2016)
- Creative and Innovative Thinking, PTCL Academy (17th Aug. 2015)
- PMP 35 PDU's (PMBOK 5th Ed.), NUST Business School (June 2013)

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Gold medalist in MBA at SZABIST (2015)
- Merit scholarship recipient for MBA (2013-2014)
- Two fast track promotions in a year in NAYAtel (2012)
- Merit Scholarship recipient for HSSC from Federal Board (FBISE) (2006-2010)
- Head Boy of the College in HSSC (2005-2006)